

Read Step

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Read steps summarize the main points presented in the watch step, along with additional explanation, detail, and examples. If any new terms were defined in the previous Watch step, the Read step should include a full, written definition with examples in more detail.

Content is organized by headings and should be succinct and straightforward with no extra "fluff." This is where you define new terms and illustrate examples with visual aids, when possible.

Example: <https://learn.skillcrush.com/module-1/the-wonderful-world-of-javascript/>

NOTE: In the *first* lesson of a class, make sure to explain the class project in its own section, and reference the class project in the lesson title.

General Flow of a Read Step

1. **Topic introduction:** Introduce the new topic or concept
 - a. Introduce the topic or concept (what it is and why we're learning it), including any relevant **definition(s)**
 - b. Provide at least 1-2 clear examples that are relevant to students of this specific course, using real-life examples
 - c. If this content was introduced in the Watch step, be sure to make the content similar, but not identical, to the Watch step.
 - i. For example, you might:
 1. Use a different example
 2. Expand upon the topic/add additional context
 3. Explain the process in a slightly different fashion, etc.
2. **Explanation of Topic & Why It's Important:** Why is this important/relevant for students?
 - a. Adult learners need to understand *why* (ex: look and feel is important because it creates consistency & all design decisions are based on it)
3. **Explanation of Workflow or Process:**
 - a. If your topic involves a step-by-step process, list each step clearly.
 - b. Include multiple concise, clear examples.
 - c. If there are code examples, use the [Code Blocks Chrome extension](#) to highlight and format the code. Use the ir-black theme.
4. **Add Images & Gifs**
 - a. Add images or gifs that will help students understanding.
 - b. It's preferable to make our own in-house images and [gifs](#) so we have all ownership and transformation rights. However, if you use an outside image/gif, be sure to indicate and link the source: *Source: Wikimedia user [Emphrase](#).*

- c. Follow [guidelines for writing captions and alt text](#) for images and gifs.
- d. Limit the amount of media that doesn't support learning. While additional graphics make the page look more exciting and colorful, extraneous media can distract from learning. The final lesson of a class is a great place for fun gifs and images because much of the learning is complete!

5. Recommended Resources

- a. If applicable, list any pro-tips, inspiration, or great websites in the Recommended Resources section.
- b. These should be additional articles/websites for students to read who want to know more, not required.

Original Content

All content should be original content. If secondary sources are used, they should be cited or placed in the Recommended Resources section.

Students value the original content that Skillcrush provides. They could Google and look for resources on their own, but the value Skillcrush provides is writing and organizing content for our learners.

Skillcrush is a for-profit company, so [factors supporting fair use](#) are weak. Plagiarism of any type, including copying exact code examples and definitions, should be avoided. When in doubt, add the content to a [plagiarism checker](#) or paste a section in Google to see if there are any exact results.

Formatting Read Steps

Headings

If you have multiple topics, you can break up each topic with a header, such as FREELANCE MARKETPLACES See an example here: [IA Models](#).

To further break up sections, you can use sub-headers, which consist of bold text and a line break. These are good when a topic has sub-topics, or when a process has individual steps.

For example, in the [IA Models](#) step, the overall lesson is broken down into two headers: COMMON IA MODELS and CHOOSING YOUR IA MODELS. Then, within COMMON IA MODELS, there are five sub-headers: Hierarchical, Hub and Spoke, Bento Box, Single Page or Sequential, and Combined.

Bullet Points

If you just need to list a few words or ideas without much detail, use the following format:

- Item one
- Item two
- Item three

If you need to list some main ideas with additional details about each, use this format:

- **Main idea in bold** - More text with additional details.
- **2nd main idea** - More details.
- **3rd main idea** - Details.

In Read steps, we don't include punctuation on bullet points unless the bullets are long enough to warrant multiple sentences,

Example: <https://learn.skillcrush.com/module-1/what-is-ux-design/>

Recommended Resources

If a Read step includes any recommended resources, whether to Skillcrush blog posts or third-party content, try to keep the number of these links minimal. Recommended resources can be included at the bottom of the read step and should follow this format:

Recommended Resources

- [Page Title 1](#): Brief, one-sentence Description.
- [Page Title 2](#): Brief, one-sentence Description
- [Example: Adobe XD Workspace Basics](#): Get to know your Adobe Workspace with any FAQs you might need answering.